



Mumbai City and East Bengal play out a draw

It was the dawn of a new era at the Mumbai Football Arena as the Islanders' faithful unsheathed a banner, which read 'The Kratky era.'

There was a vibe of optimism in the sea of blue, waiting with bated breath to watch Mumbai City FC play its first home game under the tutelage of Petr Kratky, the club's new manager after Des Buckingham's departure. To counter the rippling energy from the Mumbai fans was the age-old chants of 'Joy East Bengal' from the ones adorned in Red and Gold (above).

The balance tipped heavily in favour of Mumbai City ahead of its home clash against East Bengal, but last season's 1-0 away win against the Islanders meant that Carles Cuadrat's men had reason to believe as well. The Islanders tried to lay down the marker early in the match, with Kratky giving the Mumbai fans a glimpse of the football he expects his team to play — swift passing into the channels, making full use of the pitch and direct, attacking football.

But in the end, Kratky's first home match turned out to be anti-climactic because all that pressure resulted in just a point. The clash finished in a 0-0 draw. East Bengal, while tepid on the attacking front, showed discipline at the back and managed to earn a point despite being under pressure for most of the match.

It is early days for Kratky, however, and he, like any new coach, deserves the time to implement his philosophy. And judging by the clash against East Bengal, work remains to be done.

Aneesh Dey

Chennaiyin finally pips Bengaluru

Chennaiyin FC hadn't beaten bitter

rival Bengaluru FC in the Indian Super League for the past four years, and the Supremachans made sure they had a ball once Owen Coyle's men trumped Sunil Chhetri's side.

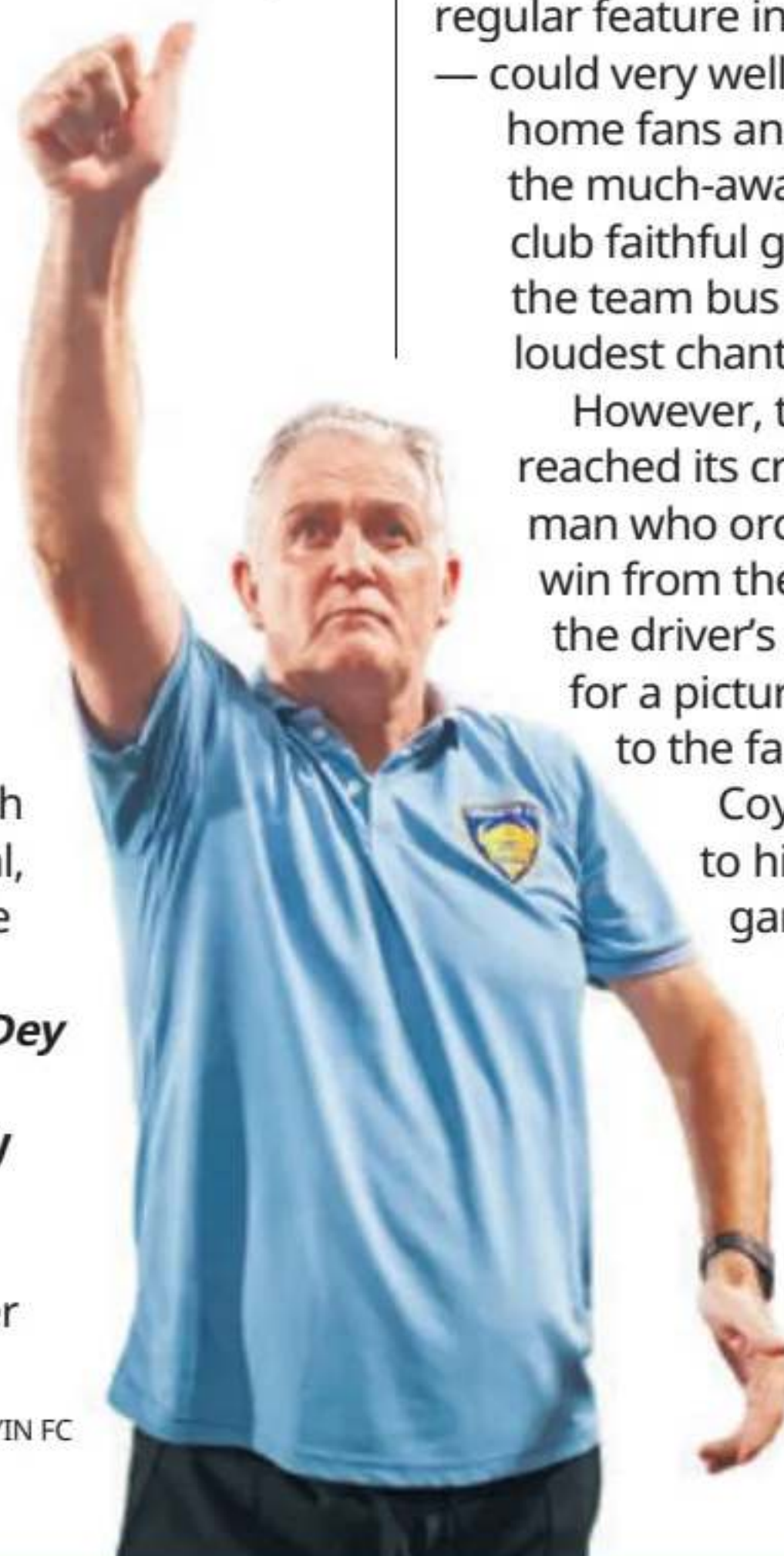
An 'unleash the beast' tifo — a regular feature in CFC home games — could very well describe how the home fans and team celebrated the much-awaited victory. The club faithful gathered close to the team bus and let out their loudest chants.

However, the decibel level reached its crescendo when the man who orchestrated their win from the sidelines sat on the driver's seat of their bus for a picture or two, obliging to the fans' request.

Coyle (left) stayed true to his words before the game:

"We want to win, not only for the points but also for our passionate fans."

Sankar Narayanan EH



CHENNAIYIN FC